Some 20,000 coalition supporters demonstrated in front of the Supreme Court and in other spots in Jerusalem. From the news photos, one gets the impression that these are essentially students from yeshivot, which doesn't make them less dangerous.

Netanyahu announced the postponement of the overhaul until the end of July, to allow time for conciliation talks. He welcomed Gantz's readiness to negotiate. The Histadrut boss immediately declared an end to the strikes. I'm not sure that the opposition will relent and wait patiently for the summer. It's probable that when the summer comes, the coalition majority, possibly after some minute changes, will push for the ratification of the overhaul package. For the time being, nobody wants to seem opposed to the time-out.

Ben-Gvir got his private army, but it will take a lot of legal work for it to become official, and beyond the legalese, there will be complicated negotiations with the police to delimit their respective domains. An official private army is a rare occurrence in a democracy.

In Tel Aviv, the demonstrations went on. To reopen Ayalon, the police used stun grenades and water cannons.

Gantz and Lapid announced their readiness to negotiate. Lapid was much more careful than Gantz: he mentioned the possibility of a trick, given his overall experience of dealing with such an inveterate trickster as Netanyahu. In any case, Herzog declared that the President's Residence was open for talks.

The coalition lost eleven mandates according to the latest polls. Gantz got twenty-two mandates, Lapid twenty-one. Likud went down from thirty-two to twenty-five. Likud Knesset members accuse Netanyahu and Levin of destroying the party.

Tuesday, March 28